

Aeva Technologies Inc. (AEVA)

Stock already reflects current award traction and opportunity set in our opinion; progress with new design wins a key focus from here; Initiate at Neutral

AEVA

12m Price Target: **\$20.00**Price: **\$18.29**Upside: **9.3%**

We initiate coverage on Aeva Technologies Inc. (AEVA) with a Neutral rating and a \$20, 12-month price target (implying 9% upside relative to our coverage median at 16% upside).

We see Aeva as one of the leaders in the lidar space, as evidenced by wins in transportation applications including with a European based top 10 global auto OEM and Daimler Trucks, its position on the Nvidia reference design, and awards in non-auto applications like precision automation and smart infrastructure. Aeva also has an opportunity to get a production award from a top 5 auto OEM, as it recently completed a development program (although we believe other lidar vendors are also being considered per our industry discussions). Importantly, Aeva has also made recent progress toward entering the datacenter market with a joint development agreement for an optical module that would be sold to a hyperscale customer, and Aeva would leverage its existing semi technology for this datacenter application. Management has also commented there is the potential to broaden its product offerings for the datacenter market.

While we expect these wins to drive revenue growth over the intermediate to long term, we see this as largely captured in the premium multiple relative to peers such as Hesai and Innoviz, and as the stock trades at a similar revenue multiple as some optical vendors. In an upside scenario, we believe Aeva could leverage its current awards and product traction into additional orders, especially in datacenter and/or higher volume auto programs. However, we also see risks including: 1) execution on program opportunities (as we believe our and Street estimates through 2028 already incorporate a degree of success in programs both in the auto and the datacenter markets); 2) a competitive market (both in lidar from merchant vendors such as Hesai and Innoviz as well as from internal efforts including from Waymo and Aurora, as well in the datacenter space from vendors such as Lumentum and

NEUTRAL

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Key Data

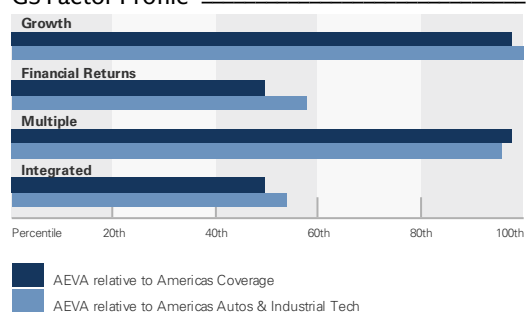
Market cap: \$1.3bn
Enterprise value: \$1.2bn
3m ADTV: \$50.0mn
United States
Americas Autos & Industrial Tech
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (\$ mn)	18.1	32.6	68.0	215.0
EBITDA (\$ mn)	(118.4)	(133.1)	(136.7)	(100.2)
EBIT (\$ mn)	(123.8)	(138.5)	(142.5)	(106.4)
EPS (\$)	(2.14)	(2.10)	(1.95)	(1.35)
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
EV/EBITDA (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
FCF yield (%)	(15.8)	(9.0)	(7.9)	(4.8)
Dividend yield (%)	—	—	—	—
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	—	—	—	—

	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (\$)	(0.54)	(0.50)	(0.50)	(0.51)

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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NEUTRAL

Aeva Technologies Inc. (AEVA)

Rating since Aug 23, 2026

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
EV/EBITDA (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
EV/sales (X)	43.1	36.4	19.6	7.1
FCF yield (%)	(15.8)	(9.0)	(7.9)	(4.8)
EV/DACF (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
CROCI (%)	(103.8)	(145.6)	(203.1)	(96.2)
ROE (%)	(216.5)	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	—	—	—	—
Net debt/equity (%)	184.7	124.1	81.0	(51.9)
Interest cover (X)	—	(29.0)	(29.7)	(22.2)
Inventory days	79.2	95.8	50.1	19.5
Receivable days	45.9	38.4	21.5	9.3
Days payable outstanding	110.4	104.8	69.4	31.1

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue growth	99.4	80.6	108.3	216.2
EBITDA growth	16.2	(12.4)	(2.6)	26.7
EPS growth	18.1	2.0	7.2	30.8
DPS growth	NM	NM	NM	NM
Gross margin	(3.7)	31.3	30.4	34.5
EBIT margin	(684.8)	(424.3)	(209.5)	(49.5)

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 21 Aug 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Total revenue	18.1	32.6	68.0	215.0
Cost of goods sold	(18.7)	(22.4)	(47.4)	(140.7)
SG&A	(41.5)	(50.8)	(56.0)	(63.7)
R&D	(81.6)	(97.9)	(107.1)	(117.0)
Other operating inc./ (exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	(118.4)	(133.1)	(136.7)	(100.2)
Depreciation & amortization	(5.4)	(5.4)	(5.8)	(6.2)
EBIT	(123.8)	(138.5)	(142.5)	(106.4)
Net interest inc./ (exp.)	2.7	(1.2)	(1.9)	(2.2)
Income/ (loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	(121.5)	(139.7)	(144.3)	(108.6)
Provision for taxes	(0.3)	(0.1)	0.0	0.0
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	(121.8)	(139.8)	(144.3)	(108.6)
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	(121.8)	(139.8)	(144.3)	(108.6)
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$)	(2.14)	(2.10)	(1.95)	(1.35)
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$)	(2.14)	(2.10)	(1.95)	(1.35)
EPS (ex-ESO exp., dil.) (\$)	--	--	--	--
DPS (\$)	—	—	—	—
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Wtd avg shares out. (basic) (mn)	57.0	66.7	74.2	80.7
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	57.0	66.7	74.2	80.7

Balance Sheet (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Cash & cash equivalents	72.3	127.2	120.0	48.6
Accounts receivable	3.4	3.5	4.5	6.5
Inventory	5.8	6.0	7.0	8.0
Other current assets	72.1	16.4	16.4	16.4
Total current assets	153.5	153.1	147.9	79.4
Net PP&E	18.3	20.1	26.7	34.3
Net intangibles	0.8	(0.2)	(1.6)	(3.4)
Total investments	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other long-term assets	7.0	6.4	6.4	6.4
Total assets	179.7	179.4	179.4	116.7
Accounts payable	5.9	7.0	11.0	13.0
Short-term debt	—	—	—	—
Current lease liabilities	1.5	2.0	2.0	2.0
Other current liabilities	28.5	20.5	20.5	20.5
Total current liabilities	35.9	29.6	33.6	35.6
Long-term debt	96.7	96.9	96.9	96.9
Non-current lease liabilities	4.2	3.4	3.4	3.4
Other long-term liabilities	29.7	74.0	74.0	74.0
Total long-term liabilities	130.6	174.3	174.3	174.3
Total liabilities	166.5	203.9	207.9	209.9
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	13.2	(24.4)	(28.5)	(93.1)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Total liabilities & equity	179.7	179.4	179.4	116.7
BVPS (\$)	0.23	(0.37)	(0.38)	(1.15)

Cash Flow (\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net income	(145.4)	(184.0)	(144.3)	(108.6)
D&A add-back	5.4	5.4	5.8	6.2
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(25.1)	(6.2)	2.0	(1.0)
Others	50.1	82.2	40.3	44.0
Cash flow from operations	(115.1)	(102.7)	(96.3)	(59.4)
Capital expenditures	(4.6)	(7.4)	(11.0)	(12.0)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	—	—	—	—
Others	34.5	50.5	—	—
Cash flow from investing	29.9	43.1	(11.0)	(12.0)
Dividends paid	—	—	—	—
Share issuance/(repurchase)	—	—	—	—
Inc/(dec) in debt	96.9	(0.3)	—	—
Others	31.7	114.8	100.0	—
Cash flow from financing	128.6	114.5	100.0	0.0
Total cash flow	43.4	54.9	(7.3)	(71.4)
Free cash flow	(119.7)	(110.1)	(107.3)	(71.4)
Free cash flow per share (basic) (\$)	(2.10)	(1.65)	(1.45)	(0.89)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

Coherent); and 3) negative free cash flow over the near to medium term.

Company background and product 101

Aeva was founded by former Apple engineers Soroush Salehian and Mina Rezk in 2017. Aeva went public through a de-SPAC transaction in March 2021. Most recently in June 2026, the company raised ~\$115 mn through a follow-on offering.

Aeva is a provider of Frequency Modulated Continuous Wave (FMCW) lidar and technology for a range of potential end markets, including automotive, industrial, robotics, and datacenter. We highlight key differences between FMCW technology and Time-of-Flight (ToF) lidar technology in the callout below.

Technology 101: FMCW vs ToF

The main difference in how the two technologies operate relates to the way in which they detect objects. A ToF system sends laser pulses at intervals and uses the time it takes the pulse to return to calculate the distance to the object. A series of these images can also be used to estimate the velocity of an object. An FMCW system, on the other hand, leverages a constant laser beam. Given that the beam is continuous, changes in the frequency can be used to determine velocity for each point. We note that both technologies have seen some success to date, with companies like Hesai and Innoviz having secured wins with ToF, and Aeva having secured wins with an FMCW approach.

The company's FMCW lidar uses silicon photonics technology for key components to support lower costs, with building blocks that include its laser, semiconductor optical amplifier (SOA), detector, and optical processing. The ability to leverage silicon photonics technology reduces system cost, per management. Aeva also provides perception and analytics software.

Importantly, Aeva does not have its own factories and leverages 3rd party manufacturers like Jabil, Fabrinet, and LG Innotek for assembly, and it partners with foundries such as TSMC and Tower Semi for its semiconductor components.

We show the key products, their end market use, and features in [Exhibit 1](#). In some configurations, the range of its lidar can reach 500 meters.

While we believe its FMCW lidar could offer certain performance benefits (e.g., on range and velocity), Aeva's targeted price point in the mid to high hundreds of dollars for autos and low to mid \$1K range in trucking is above that of several ToF offerings (which can be priced in the low to mid hundreds of dollars range per unit at scale based on our industry discussions).

Separately and importantly, Aeva's semiconductor optical amplifier (SOA) technology is a key part of what Aeva is bringing to the datacenter market. Aeva expects to be able to leverage its already developed semi technology for the initial JDA in an optical module, and management has also commented there is the potential to broaden its product offerings for the datacenter market (e.g., potentially a TOSA).

Exhibit 1: Aeva offers primarily lidar products for a range of applications/end markets

Product	Range	Key Specifications	Primary End Markets
Atlas	up to 250 m	Auto grade, 120x30 FOV, -40 to 85 degree Celsius operating range	Autos, Industrials
Atlas Ultra	up to 500 m	Auto grade, 3x resolution and 35% slimmer vs Atlas, 120x25 FOV	Autos
Atlas Orion	up to 200 m for VRUs; up to 500 for vehicles	120 wide FOV, 0.05x0.05 angular resolution	Smart Infrastructure, Security
Omni	up to 80 m	360x90 FOV, 85 mm diameter, -40 to 60 degree Celsius operating range	Automation, Robotics, and Smart Infrastructure
Eve1	N/A	Up to sub-micron precision, 0.01% linearity, 100 mm to 20 m standoff range	Manufacturing, Automation
CityOS	N/A	Continuously detects and classifies road users and detect patterns	Smart Infrastructure
SOA	N/A	Optical output power exceeding 28 dBm, wall-plug efficiencies greater than 20%, at temperatures up to 50 degrees Celsius	Datacenter

VRU = vulnerable road user (e.g. pedestrian or cyclist)

Source: Company data

Timeline of key events and awards

We show key awards and announcements from Aeva in [Exhibit 2](#). We note that the company has announcements beyond this and the list is non-exhaustive.

Exhibit 2: Key announcements and awards for Aeva

Date	Announcement	End Market
8/10/2021	Nikon strategic collaboration	Industrial Automation
8/1/2022	SICK collaboration announced	Industrial Automation
11/6/2023	Nikon production agreement	Industrial Automation
11/8/2023	May Mobility long-range lidar award	Autos & Trucking
1/3/2024	Global trucking OEM series award	Autos & Trucking
1/9/2024	Daimler named as the series award	Autos & Trucking
12/2/2024	SICK collaboration expanded	Industrial Automation
3/19/2025	European based Global Top 10 OEM development program	Autos & Trucking
5/14/2025	LG Innotek manufacturing agreement	N/A (Strategic partner/investor)
7/31/2025	Bendix collaboration agreement	Autos & Trucking
12/3/2025	European based Global Top 10 OEM award won	Autos & Trucking
1/20/2026	Forterra win for AGVs	Defense
2/26/2026	Top 5 OEM development program	Autos & Trucking
3/31/2026	CityOS award for Georgia	Smart Infrastructure
6/10/2026	CityOS award for Fargo	Smart Infrastructure
6/16/2026	Bendix development program	Autos & Trucking
8/5/2026	Hyperscaler Optical JDA	Datacenter

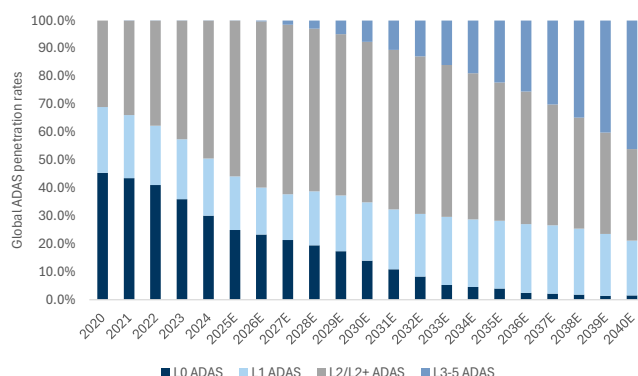
Source: Company data

Transportation: traction with select OEMs with potential for additional awards

Within the auto space, Aeva has a production award with a top 10 auto OEM for their business outside of China. We believe that, similar to other auto program ramps, this will start with 1-2 models and scale over time, with an initial start of production (SOP) of 2028. As of 1Q26, Aeva management noted it was working with the OEM and their AV tech stack provider to integrate the Aeva Atlas Ultra lidar.

Separately in autos, Aeva was recently awarded a development contract with a top 5 global passenger OEM, which management believes could convert to a series production award by the end of the year (although we believe per our industry discussions that this OEM could be considering other lidar options too). We note that the top 10 OEM program followed a similar timeline, with 4-6 months between development contract and series production award. Aeva also has further opportunities to win automotive business in our opinion, in part from having been included as part of Nvidia's reference design for autonomous vehicles.

Importantly, we do expect adoption of L3 (situationally eyes-off) and higher levels of autonomy to grow meaningfully over the intermediate to longer-term, and we show our expectations for L3-L5 autonomy by region over time in Exhibit 3 (as detailed in our April AV deep dive). However, the extent to which lidar is utilized for the L3+ platforms and which technology/players are able to win remains debated. For example, Rivian's upcoming lidar-based platform does not appear to utilize Western lidar companies, and Tesla's approach to autonomy does not rely on lidar. Additionally, Stellantis has discussed using Wavve for its autonomy platform, which doesn't require lidar, though it does support it. While Ford and GM have both discussed potential lidar use, both companies are targeting SOPs in 2028 for L3 (we believe initially on a limited number of vehicles). Finally, the high cost of L3 systems has been a headwind to adoption while features were limited per media reports, and we think L3 features will need to be able to be used at higher speeds and on more roads for adoption to rise. The range and capabilities of new lidars, including Atlas, can help L3/L4 autonomy to be supported at full highway speeds in our opinion, and drive higher overall adoption.

Exhibit 3: We expect continued adoption of higher levels of ADAS through 2040


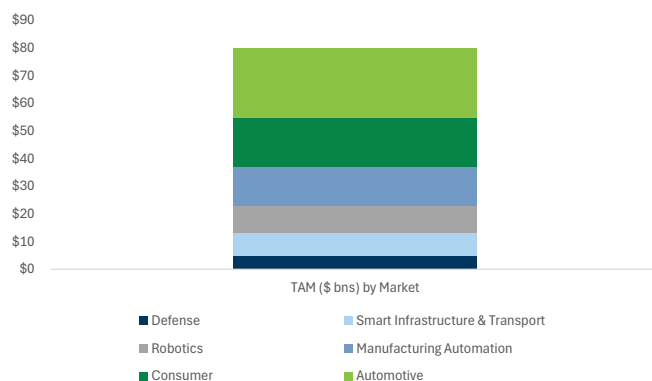
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Wards, IHS

Separately in commercial trucks, Aeva has won business with Daimler Trucks for its AV platform, providing the long-range and ultra-long range lidar, with a target SOP of 2027. Finally, in June 2026, the company was awarded a development program with Bendix for next-gen active safety (L2+) for commercial vehicles.

At its investor day, the company outlined a TAM for autos and trucking of \$25 bn. Based on our L3-L5 forecast for light vehicles and trucking, at a representative ASP of \$300-\$800 per lidar across the market (with industry average selling prices closer to the middle to lower end for light vehicles as volume ramps, and likely towards the middle to higher-end for trucking), we estimate that the total auto and trucking lidar market globally could be ~\$1+ bn in 2028 and \$3-6 bn in 2030 (though we note not all of this will be filled by merchant providers, as Aurora and Waymo utilize their own lidar).

Opportunities in non-autos, including datacenter, could provide further growth

Beyond the auto market, the company stated it expects to have opportunities in several areas including defense, smart infrastructure, robotics, manufacturing automation, and consumer applications. Aeva believes these opportunities together account for ~\$55 bn of its \$80 bn TAM outlined at its investor day, ([Exhibit 4](#)) which doesn't include datacenter. ASPs and margins in non-auto applications tend to be higher for lidar industry participants.

Exhibit 4: Aeva's TAM by end market

Source: Company data

In January 2026, the company also introduced a semiconductor optical amplifier offering for datacenters to support CPO and NPO (co-packaged and near-packaged optics). Notably, on its 2Q26 earnings call, the company announced a joint development agreement with a high-speed optical engine provider to integrate Aeva's optical sources into a module for deployment at a hyperscaler, with initial deployment targeted for 2H27 and a production ramp in 2028. Management noted that the company will work on integration in the coming months and, if qualified, will begin deployments. We believe this is an important step toward addressing the datacenter market, and the ability to successfully qualify this product could lead to further traction and serve as a proof point that the company is able to compete with incumbents such as Lumentum and Coherent. Management believes the datacenter opportunity overall is large. The company estimates this one opportunity where it has the JDA has the potential to be hundreds of millions of annual revenue (this would be for its share of the program).

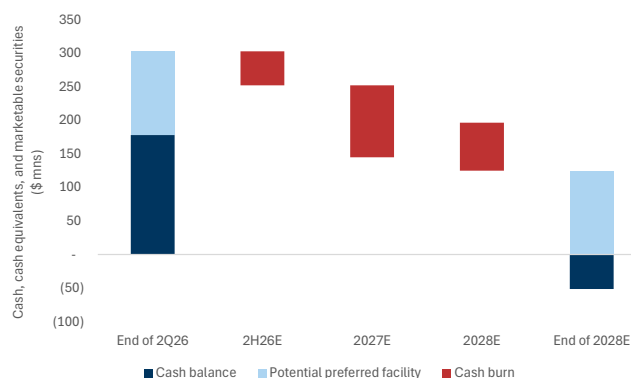
Beyond datacenter, to date, the company has had a few key wins and partnerships in the non-auto space, including with Nikon, SICK, and Forterra. With Nikon, per a company release, Aeva is providing its Eve sensor for automated robotic inspection and metrology applications as part of a multi-year production agreement. With SICK, Aeva sensors are sold for a variety of industrial measurement applications integrated by SICK, a provider of automation solutions. The company also has several awards for its CityOS offering, which combines its lidar with perception and analytics software for traffic and intersection management. Finally, the defense market, within which the company announced its first major win with Forterra, has accounted for a double digit percent of revenue in recent quarters, although we think revenue into this market will be somewhat lumpy. Given the longer time between award and production in autos, we see the non-auto market as a potential opportunity to derive more near-term profit.

Balance sheet and cash flow considerations

At the end of 2Q26, Aeva had ~\$178 mn in cash, cash equivalents, and marketable securities. The company has had a negative free cash flow of ~\$25-\$30 mn per quarter (or ~\$100-\$120 mn annually) over the past two years, and we expect FCF to remain negative through the modeled period (i.e., through 2028). Beyond its existing cash balance, the company also has a standby equity purchase of up to \$125 mn in

non-voting preferred stock which would be entitled to a 7% per annum quarterly dividend. We show the total available liquidity at the end of 2Q including the facility, and our expectations for FCF through the model period in [Exhibit 5](#). We note that we assume the company issues common equity in 2027 as opposed to exercising the preferred share facility.

Exhibit 5: Aeva FCF and cash balance bridge



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Beyond the FCF and preferred share facility considerations, we also note that the company has \$100 mn in aggregate principal of 4.375% convertible notes due 2032 that can be converted at an initial conversion price of \$15.8643 per share. These converts are not currently reflected in the diluted sharecount due to the anti-dilutive impact. Should the full debt be converted, it would result in ~6 mn shares being issued.

We see valuation as reasonable relative to growth

From a competitive standpoint, Aeva competes with several companies globally, including Hesai, Innoviz, and RoboSense for automotive applications and Ouster for non-auto applications. Aeva also competes with in-house technology (e.g., Aurora and Waymo utilize internally developed lidar technology). Beyond transportation, Aeva competes with companies like Lumentum and Coherent in the datacenter vertical.

We see valuation as reasonable given Aeva's growth profile and wins to date, with Aeva trading higher than Innoviz and relatively in line to Ouster, and Lumentum on our 2028 estimates that already incorporate \$100+ million of datacenter related revenue. We show valuation and revenue growth against key peers in [Exhibit 6](#).

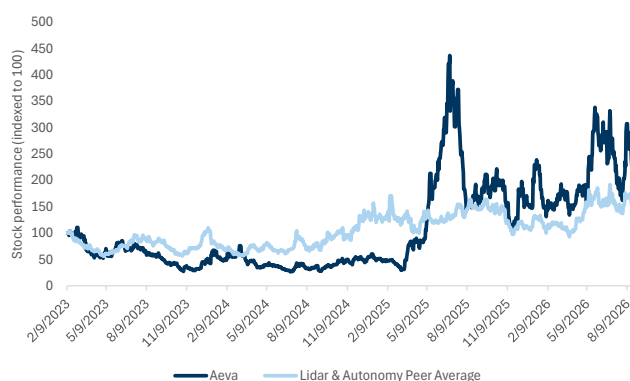
Exhibit 6: AEVA valuation vs peers

Ticker	Price	EV (\$ mns)	2028 sales growth	2028 gross margin	EV/2027 sales	EV/2028 sales
AUR	\$6.24	11,113	203%	29.1%	89.5x	29.5x
MBLY	\$9.03	6,087	9%	65.6%	2.9x	2.6x
INVZ	\$0.34	22	19%	33.2%	0.3x	0.2x
OUST	\$38.42	2,362	32%	44.0%	7.9x	6.0x
LITE	\$866.71	74,696	45%	51.3%	9.5x	6.6x
COHR	\$289.52	60,057	33%	42.3%	4.8x	3.6x
HSAI	\$2.38	2,235	28%	51.4%	2.5x	1.9x
AEVA	\$18.29	1,175	216%	35.5%	17.3x	5.5x

Price as of market close on 8/21; Gross margin is ex. SBC

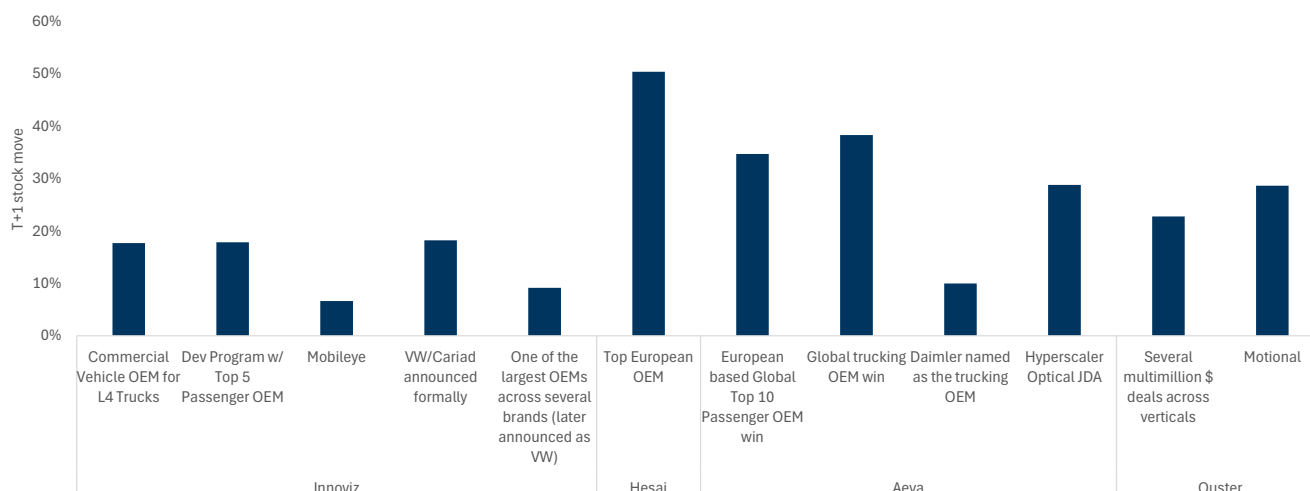
Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

We show how Aeva shares have traded over time, relative to a broader set of lidar and autonomy peers on an equal weight basis (i.e., average performance across HSAI, MBLY, AUR, OUST, INVZ).

Exhibit 7: Aeva stock performance vs lidar & autonomy peers February 2023-August 2026

Source: FactSet

While Aeva shares have been volatile, large design wins have historically been key drivers of stock performance for the industry ([Exhibit 8](#)).

Exhibit 8: Key wins for lidar companies and the stock move on the trading day following the announcement

Source: Company data, FactSet

Our estimates at the EBIT level are relatively in line with consensus, although our EPS estimates are less negative driven by an assumption for more dilution from equity grants and issuance. Based on our expectations and company commentary around high-level sizing of the existing awards, as well as potential business management expects to convert and/or announce over the near-term, we believe that our and consensus estimates incorporate a solid level of ramp and success against target volumes for existing programs, including in datacenter and/or potential success in winning additional business or content.

Exhibit 9: GS vs Street 2026-28E

	2026E		2027E		2028E	
	GS	Street	GS	Street	GS	Street
Revenue (\$ mns)	33	31	68	71	215	208
EBIT (inc. SBC; \$ mns)	(139)	(131)	(142)	(135)	(106)	(101)
EPS ex. SBC	(\$1.57)	(\$1.56)	(\$1.40)	(\$1.62)	(\$0.80)	(\$1.06)

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Estimates, price target, and key risks

Our EPS estimates including SBC are $-\$2.10/-\$1.95/-\$1.35$ for 2026/27/28 respectively. Excluding SBC, we model EPS of $-\$1.57/-\$1.40/-\$0.80$ respectively.

Our 12-month price target is \$20, which is based on 1) 90% weight of our base case of \$19, based on 7X EV/2028 sales (with the premium relative to peers reflecting the award traction) discounted back; 2) 5% weight on our bull case of \$48, based on 9X EV/an upside 2028 sales scenario (which is twice our base case) discounted back; and 3) a 5% weight on our bear case of \$4, based on 3X EV/a downside 2028 scenario (which is half our base case) discounted back.

Key risks to our view include: 1) Ability to win new business - if Aeva is able to win more/less production awards, both in autos and non-autos (including datacenter), than we expect, this could drive upside/downside; 2) ASPs - if Aeva's revenue per lidar is higher/lower than we expect, it could lead to higher/lower revenue and relatedly

upside/downside to the stock; 3) Trade policy - Aeva utilizes 3rd parties like Jabil and Fabrinet who manufacture globally, including Mexico and APAC. Adverse trade decisions could lead to higher costs and potential downside; and 4) Input costs - if metals, semis, and other component prices are higher/lower than we expect, this could drive downside/upside to the stock.

Disclosure Appendix

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